# Neurology Service Line Handbook

MERIDIAN HEALTH PARTNERS
DEPARTMENT OF NEUROLOGY: SERVICE LINE HANDBOOK
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## SECTION 1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

1.1. This handbook establishes the operational parameters, service definitions, insurance coverage tiers, and access commitments for the Neurology department across all fourteen Meridian Health Partners outpatient facilities.

1.2. Compliance with this handbook is mandatory for all administrative staff, scheduling coordinators, and clinical personnel within the Neurology service line.

## SECTION 2. CONDITIONS ACCEPTED AND EXPLICITLY NOT ACCEPTED

2.1. Accepted Conditions: The Neurology department accepts adult patients presenting with chronic headache disorders, suspected neurodegenerative conditions, peripheral neuropathies, focal motor deficits, seizure disorders requiring outpatient management, and movement disorders.

2.2. Explicitly Not Accepted Conditions: The department does not accept patients presenting with acute stroke symptoms within the active thrombolytic window (under 4.5 hours from onset), active neurosurgical emergencies requiring immediate operative intervention, pediatric neurology cases (patients under 18 years of age), or acute traumatic brain injuries. Such presentations must be redirected immediately to the nearest emergency department.

## SECTION 3. APPOINTMENT DURATION AND SERVICE TIMELINE COMMITMENTS

3.1. Standard New-Patient Consultation: The standard new-patient consultation shall be scheduled for exactly 45 minutes.

3.2. Service Duration Limits: All neurological services run between 45 and 60 minutes as defined in Section 5 of this handbook. No appointment slot within this service line shall be scheduled for less than 45 minutes.

3.3. First Appointment Offer Commitment: The Neurology department commits to offering a first appointment within 11 calendar days of an accepted referral.

3.4. Referral Turnaround: Referral processing turnaround times are governed exclusively by the Meridian-wide Referral Management Policy (MHP-REF-POL-002). Staff shall consult that document for processing windows and shall not apply divergent internal timelines.

## SECTION 4. PATIENT PREPARATION INSTRUCTIONS

4.1. General Consultations (NEUR-CONS): Patients attending a standard consultation must bring all historical neuroimaging discs or digital access credentials, a complete physical list of current medications with dosages, and completed intake questionnaire form MHP-NEUR-Q1.

4.2. MRI Brain (NEUR-MRI): Patients scheduled for an MRI Brain must be screened for metallic implants, pacemakers, and severe claustrophobia at least 24 hours prior to arrival. Patients must arrive 30 minutes before the scheduled appointment time for pre-scan safety verification.

4.3. Nerve Conduction Study (NEUR-NCS): Patients scheduled for a Nerve Conduction Study must not apply lotions, oils, or powders to their skin on the day of the test. Skin must be clean and dry to ensure accurate electrode adhesion and signal recording.

## SECTION 5. PROCEDURE SCHEDULE AND PLAN COVERAGE MATRIX

5.1. The following table defines the billing codes, list prices, durations, and pre-authorisation requirements across the four Meridian Health Partners insurance plans.

| Procedure Code & Description | List Price | Duration | MERIDIAN-GOLD | MERIDIAN-SILVER | MERIDIAN-BRONZE | CIVIC-BASE |
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| NEUR-CONS<br>Neurology Consultation | $230 | 45 min | Covered<br>No pre-auth | Covered<br>No pre-auth | Covered<br>No pre-auth | Covered<br>No pre-auth |
| NEUR-MRI<br>MRI Brain | $1,650 | 45 min | Covered<br>No pre-auth | Covered<br>Pre-auth: 3 business days | Covered<br>Pre-auth: 5 business days | Covered<br>Pre-auth: 5 business days |
| NEUR-NCS<br>Nerve Conduction Study | $780 | 60 min | Covered<br>Pre-auth: 2 business days | Covered<br>Pre-auth: 3 business days | Covered<br>Pre-auth: 5 business days | Covered<br>Pre-auth: 7 business days |

5.2. Authorisation Enforcement: No clinical procedure listed above may be performed without fulfilling the pre-authorisation timeframe specified for the patient's exact insurance plan tier. Scheduling staff shall verify authorisation status prior to confirming appointment slots requiring pre-clearance.